Datar had come to Dubai earlier in 1975 after serving a stint in the Air India, spending the next decade working as a grocer in Jebel Ali.

Overcoming the initial challenges, the Datars won the trust of the Indian expatriate community and emerged as a shop of their choice. The secret of their success is that they had their fingers on the pulse of the expatriate Indian community, giving them the right products at the right time. Resultant, the market wisdom was that at Adil Stores you will always get what you want!

Evolving from these small beginnings as a family run business into a modern, specialist supermarket chain selling the entire range of grocery and household items including Indian spices and masalas, pulses, rice and flour, oils and ghee, pickles and chutneys, tea and coffee, canned and instant foods, Ayurveda herbs, cosmetics, dry fruits, mouth fresheners and savouries and sweetmeats the group expanded its footprint across the GCC universe, Adil Stores has since become a household name among Indians and other nationalities in the UAE.

The company has set up a manufacturing unit in the Al Quoz industrial area of Dubai where it produces masalas, spices, pickles, flours, pulses and other Indian foodstuff items under the Peacock brand name. It also has an Indian arm, Masala King Exports in Mumbai (India), which is one of the leading exporters of quality branded Indian pulses, spices and other grocery items as well as non-food Items in the Indian sub-continent. Today Dhananjay's group encompasses a chain of 50 spacious superstores spread across the Gulf Countries, 2 spice factories, 2 flour mills equipped with modern technology, and an import-export company. He has created employment for hundreds of Indian workers and given them the opportunity to work abroad.

"I have always followed the path of hard work. My mantra has been - Determination-Honesty-Customer Service-Courtesy", says Dhananjay. And this has been the mantra for success - which turned a small shopkeeper into a billionaire and the Masala King of Dubai. With patience he worked passionately and expanded the number of superstores in UAE and neighbouring Gulf countries. In 38 years, he has successfully created the world-famous business group Adil, out of a tiny shop.

Adil Trading under the leadership of Dhananjay has performed the key role of bringing more than 9000 Indian products to UAE. For the last 38 years, he has been serving the Indian community in the Gulf region with authentic, hygienic and safe Indian foodstuff. His group's Indian arm, Masala King Exports (India) Pvt. Ltd. is one of the leading exporters of quality branded Indian pulses, spices, and other grocery items, as well as non-food items from the Indian sub-continent. It is for this invaluable contribution that the rulers of UAE felicitated Dhananjay with a prestigious award and the title of Masala King in 2001.

Adil Group is in active expansion mode and increasing its outlets in other Gulf countries. It has established special trade routes in the USA, Canada, Kenya, Switzerland, Italy, Eritrea, Kuwait, Oman, Bahrain, Saudi Arabia, and UAE.

Apart from business, Dhananjay encourages entrepreneurship among Indian youth. He has helped a number of local entrepreneurs from India in exporting their quality products to Gulf markets. "My wife Vandana and sons Hrishikesh and Rohit have been of immense support in the group's growth. Vandana has implemented financial discipline and management in the group, whereas Hrishikesh and Rohit have added latest technologies like Artificial intelligence, E-Commerce, Online Marketing etc.", says Dhananjay.

Dhananjay has been honored with various international and national awards for excellence and quality. He has also been recognised by Forbes Middle East by being ranked 25th as well as being ranked 8th by Arabian Business in the Arab world. He has been conferred with business awards from countries like UAE, USA, UK, France, Germany, Switzerland, and Spain. India has honored him with the GMBF Business Excellence Award, Rashtriya Udyog Ratna Award, Quality Brand Award, Bharat Vikas Ratan Award and Best Indian Retailer Award.

Apart from business, Dhananjay has been acclaimed for his philanthropic work and contribution to social service. He has donated generously to orphanages, schools for underprivileged children and for social welfare projects run by eminent social workers. He has been honoured with a special award for his contribution in social entrepreneurship by Master Deenanath Mangeshkar Smruti Prathishthan, Mumbai.



VANDANA DATAR, Finance Director
HRISHIKESH DATAR, Purchase Director
ROHIT DATAR, Marketing Director